

Vo6 Virtual Promotional Photography

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will demonstrate their creativity and skills in photography and image editing. This national event will be submitted and judged virtually. Any middle level, secondary or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. Contestants who do not submit an entry following the topic listed below or do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

Through the Frame. Create a photograph that uses a *natural* or *constructed* frame to draw the viewer’s attention toward the main subject. A frame may include doors, windows, archways, tree branches, mirrors, fences, shadows, or any structural or environmental element that surrounds or partially encloses the focal point.

Competition Notes

- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register contestants for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>
 - Click on the “Conferences” tab and then select the “2027 National Virtual Events”
 - There will be a \$10 fee for each entry (*invoiced during event registration*)
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after contestant registration
 - The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on December 1, 2026
 - Contestants participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	National Deadline
1. Original Photo as JPG 2. Edited Photo as JPG 3. Works Cited, BPA Release Form(s) and AI Usage and Documentation Form in one combined PDF	VO6-ContestantID-Original.jpg VO6-ContestantID-Edited.jpg VO6-ContestantID.pdf	January 15, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Apply professional camera techniques, including proper focus, intentional shot composition, and creative framing strategies to capture compelling, high-quality images
2. Demonstrate knowledge of lighting principles, exposure settings, and shutter speed to achieve consistent and technically sound photographic output
3. Demonstrate proficiency in industry-standard photography software and equipment to manage all phases of the photographic production process, including digital editing and image refinement
4. Demonstrate knowledge of copyright laws and ethical standards as they apply to the creation, use, and distribution of photographic work
5. Demonstrate an understanding of audience analysis by designing and delivering a final photographic product that effectively communicates to a defined target audience

Contest Specifications for this Event

- Photographs must be in digital format. Each file must be no larger than 5 megabytes, must be in a JPEG or JPG format and must be at least 1,600 pixels wide or 1,600 pixels tall, OR image size must have a long dimension of at least 1,000 pixels and no more than 3,000 pixels.
- The photograph, in its entirety, must be an original work of art by the contestant.
- Minor burning, dodging, and/or color correction are acceptable as are hand tinting and cropping. Adding any type of text or watermark to the photo will not be accepted.
- Submit the one (1) original photo as a JPG, one (1) edited photo as JPG as individual files along with one combined PDF file of the Works Cited, BPA Release Form(s), and the AI Usage and Documentation Form to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on January 15, 2027.
- Advisors of qualifying contestants will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Contestants will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation.
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than seven (7) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- Contestants with the highest cumulative technical and presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase.
- For contestants advancing to the National Showcase, photos must meet the following specifications:
 - Display shows original photo on 5"x7" and final photo on 8"x10" photo paper, dry-mounted on a board no larger than 24"x18". A title for the photo must be included on the board. Only the two photos and title may be on the board
 - Photos can be mounted on the board horizontally or vertically
 - You may print in glossy or matte

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Contestant ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered members and/or those missing Contestant ID cannot be accepted.
- The contestant is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including oneself, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The contestant is responsible for citing all sources, including oneself, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

Vo6 Virtual Promotional Photography Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
The contestant submitted both the original and edited photos in JPG format.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to any question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Contestant submitted one (1) original photo as a JPG, one (1) corrected photo as a JPG, and on combined PDF of the Works Cited formatted according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> , BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form.				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 1-13 points	Meets Expectations 14-27 points	Above Expectations 28-40 points	Points Awarded
Technical Photo Quality	The original photo and/or edited photo does not meet format, size, or dimension requirements, or the image is unclear, poorly composed, or of low quality.	Both photos meet all technical requirements and is clear, well-framed, and appropriate for their intended use.	Both photos exceed technical standards with exceptional clarity, composition, and visual appeal, showing creativity or professional-level quality.	/40
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 1-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-20 points	Points Awarded
Creativity & Originality	Both photos lack creativity and originality. They use basic composition resulting in a dull and unremarkable image(s).	Both photos show creative effort, with interesting choices in perspective that add visual appeal.	Both photos are highly creative, using unique angles or framing to create a visually striking and original image.	/20
Image Quality	Both photos lack sharpness or clarity, appears blurry or pixelated, and shows poor use of depth of field, making the subject unclear or distracting.	Both photos are in focus, clear, and uses depth of field appropriately to highlight the subject. The image is technically sound and visually balanced.	Both photos are exceptionally sharp and clear, with expert use of depth of field that enhances the subject and overall composition. The image demonstrates a high level of technical skill and visual impact.	/20
Lighting & Exposure	Both photos show poor lighting or exposure control, with areas that are noticeably overexposed or underexposed. Lighting does not enhance the subject or mood and may distract from the overall image.	Both photos demonstrate adequate lighting and exposure control. The subject is well-lit, and the image avoids major exposure issues. Lighting contributes positively to the mood and clarity of the photo.	Both photos feature expertly controlled lighting and exposure, enhancing the subject and creating a compelling mood. The use of light is intentional and artistic, with no distracting exposure flaws.	/20

Vo6 Promotional Photography

Technical Scoring Rubric (Cont'd)

Composition	Both photos lack intentional composition. The subject may be poorly placed or framed, and there is little evidence of using compositional techniques to guide the viewer's eye or enhance the image.	Both photos demonstrate a clear understanding of basic composition principles. The subject is thoughtfully placed, and techniques like the rule of thirds or leading lines are used to create visual balance and focus.	Both photos showcase exceptional compositional skill. The arrangement within the frame is deliberate and creative, using advanced techniques to draw attention, create depth, and enhance storytelling through visual structure.	/20
Editing Skill & Effectiveness	The edited photo shows excessive or inappropriate editing that detracts from the image quality or authenticity. Manipulation is obvious or poorly executed, affecting the overall impact.	The edited photo includes minor, well-applied adjustments such as subtle burning, dodging, color correction, or cropping. Edits enhance the image without being distracting or altering the original intent.	The edited photo demonstrates expert-level editing with precise and tasteful adjustments. Manipulation is seamless and enhances the image's clarity, mood, and composition while maintaining authenticity.	/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/150

Vo6 Virtual Promotional Photography

Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements				
(If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 1-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-20 points	Points Awarded
Delivery	Presentation lacks clarity and structure; communication is ineffective, with low engagement and limited topic understanding.	Presentation is organized and clear; communication is appropriate, with reasonable engagement and mostly accurate content.	Presentation is well-structured and engaging; the contestant communicates effectively, shows strong enthusiasm, and delivers accurate, insightful content.	/20
Lighting	Lighting is poorly executed; inconsistent exposure and ineffective technique result in a distracting or flat image.	Lighting suits the subject and scene, with well-controlled exposure and effective use of flash, studio, or natural light.	Lighting is intentional and effective, with expert exposure and techniques that enhance subject, mood, and impact.	/20
Camera Setting	Limited understanding of camera settings; choices appear random, leading to technical flaws like motion blur or poor exposure.	Basic understanding of settings; choices are mostly appropriate, with clear explanation of shutter speed, aperture, and ISO use.	Strong command of camera settings; intentional choices enhance the image, with clear links between technical decisions and creative outcomes.	/20
Audience Engagement	Contestant struggles to connect with the audience and does not clearly communicate the photo's theme. Delivery lacks energy, and the message is unclear or disconnected from the image.	Contestant maintains audience interest and communicates the photo's theme with clarity. Delivery is confident and appropriate, helping the audience understand the connection between the image and its message.	Contestant captivates the audience with dynamic and engaging delivery. The theme of the photo is communicated with clarity and impact, creating a strong emotional or intellectual connection between the image and the audience.	/20
Judges Questions	Responses lack clarity or depth; contestant shows limited understanding of content and choices.	Responses are clear and confident; contestant shows solid understanding of photo and choices.	Responses are clear, confident, and insightful; contestant explains technical and creative choices with depth.	/20
Timing	Setup lasted no more than three (3) minutes, and presentation lasted no more than seven (7) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/110

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT SEVEN (7) MINUTES